

Samsung LS17E34C LCD TV

Two for the price of two

The sleek-looking Samsung LS17E34C LCD TV is both—an LCD monitor and a TV, with connector slots for TV antenna, DVD, VCR, and any other A/V device. And it comes equipped with Dolby surround sound, making the audio experience as good as the video.

Setting up the TV function on the LCD is a simple, one-step process—all you do is plug the cable into the back panel, and start the channel scan. It lets you scan the available channels and auto-store them. Of course, you can also manually sort them in any order. It also lets you rename channels with a mnemonic, which means you can name your sports channel Tendulkar, or your movie channel, Shahrukh.

You can choose from four pre-defined picture standards—Dynamic, Standard, Movie and Custom. Besides this, you can also view it in the default 4:3 mode, or magnify it, or even switch to the 16:9 wide mode. This is useful specially while switching from TV to DVD mode.

The Picture-in-Picture (PIP) function allows you to watch a movie even as you work on the PC. The PIP feature comes with three window sizes.

It would be worthwhile to mention a design hitch: The LCD's control buttons are provided on the top, making it cumbersome to reach and adjust. This is partly fixed by the multi-function remote. It comes with a Kensington lock to make it theft proof, a device sorely needed for an expensive lifestyle product like this.



- **Specifications:** 17-inch screen, 140 x 125 viewable angle, 1280 x 1024 at 75 Hz display resolution, built in TV tuner, HDTV, Virtual Dolby Surround, 58W power consumption, 7.7 kg with stand
- **Price:** Rs 74,990
- **Contact:** Samsung India Electronics Ltd
- **Phone:** 011-51511234 ■ **Fax:** 011-51608818
- **E-mail:** digimax@samsungindia.com
- **Web site:** www.samsungindia.com
- **Overall Rating:** ★★★★★

Philips Micro Hi-Fi System MC-i200

Music from the Net



- **Specifications:** 1500 W PMPO, 70 signal-to-noise ratio, 50-16,000 Hz frequency response, RJ45 input jack, FM, AM, MW player, three-way bass reflex system
- **Price:** Rs 34,990
- **Contact:** Philips India Ltd
- **Phone:** 022-5691-2331, ■ **Fax:** 022-26879276
- **E-mail:** r.datta@philips.com
- **Web site:** : www.philips.com
- **Overall Rating:** ★★★★★

The Philips Micro Hi-Fi system MC-i200 plays streaming media live from the Internet, apart from AM or FM radio and the mandatory audio and MP3 CDs. It has a five-line display, a neat button layout and one-touch keys such as PC link, CD, Tuner, Connect, etc. It needs Internet connectivity to play streaming music with the help of the LAN connector. A simple process helps you configure networking details such as IP address, subnet mask, etc without much of a hassle. Choose one of the many streaming Web sites that its panel displays to listen to music of your style.

You can also configure its MyStreams section at my.philips.com to suit your musical tastes.

The audio player can also play streams sourced over your own LAN network using Philips PC-Link software. Sans the LAN, you end up paying more for features you are never going to use.

Quality-wise, this system is as good as any other audio player. However, the maximum volume level seems to be a little low. At this price tag, you may be better off buying a full-featured music system or a home theatre, or even a PC with a 5.1 speaker setup.

